

George Orwell

George Orwell was the pen name of Eric Arthur Blair, an English novelist, essayist, and critic born in Motihari, Bengal Presidency, British India on 25 June 1903. His father Richard Blair worked in the Opium Department of the Indian Civil Service.

Orwell was educated at St Cyprian's School in Eastbourne and at Eton College, where he was taught by Aldous Huxley. From 1922 to 1927 he served in the Indian Imperial Police in Burma, an experience that turned him against imperialism and inspired his first novel, "Burmese Days" (1934).

"Animal Farm" was published on 17 August 1945 by Secker and Warburg in London. The allegorical novella tells of farm animals who revolt against their human farmer, only to be ruled by pigs. The character Napoleon is based on Joseph Stalin; Snowball on Leon Trotsky; and Old Major on Karl Marx and Vladimir Lenin.

"Nineteen Eighty-Four" was published on 8 June 1949 by Secker and Warburg. It introduced terms like "Big Brother", "doublethink", and "thoughtcrime" into the English language. The novel was written at Barnhill, a remote farmhouse on the Scottish island of Jura.

Orwell died of tuberculosis on 21 January 1950 at University College Hospital in London, aged 46.